The Cloud Engineer's 20%: Seven Trust Assumptions That Unlock 80% of Cloud Security

Cloud security fails not from ignorance of IAM policies—but from misunderstanding **where trust boundaries shift** when infrastructure becomes API-driven. Master these seven leverage points, and you'll intuitively navigate 80% of cloud misconfigurations before they cause breaches.

🔑 **Concept 1: Identity Becomes the Perimeter — Not IP Addresses**
Why it unlocks 80%: In cloud environments, workloads have dynamic IPs and no fixed network perimeter. Trust shifts entirely to identity assertions (AWS IAM roles, Azure Managed Identities). Misunderstanding this causes engineers to apply network-centric controls (firewalls) while ignoring identity escalation paths.

🧪 **15-Minute Lab: Trace an Identity Trust Chain**
```bash

# Step 1: Assume an EC2 role (simulated via AWS CLI config)

aws sts get-caller-identity # See current identity context

# Step 2: Enumerate trust relationships

aws iam get-role --role-name YourRole | jq '.Role.AssumeRolePolicyDocument'
```

Step 3: Simulate privilege escalation via trust boundary crossing

Create a role that trusts your current identity:

```
cat > trust-policy.json <<EOF
{
"Version": "2012-10-17",
"Statement": [{
"Effect": "Allow",
"Principal": {"AWS": "arn:aws:iam::123456789012:user/attacker"},
"Action": "sts:AssumeRole"
}]
}
EOF
```

→ This policy delegates trust to an external identity without MFA condition